



NEED TO KNOW

- › **Monopoly** Situation in which there is just one supplier of a particular product or service; without government control, a company with a monopoly could make prices high and quality low, as consumers would have no alternative
- › **Oligopoly** Industries that have a small number of suppliers. The competition is not as intense as in the free market, so governments often impose regulations on companies to ensure quality and fair prices
- › **Remuneration** Money paid for work or a service provided—the financial term for pay; may include bonuses or share options

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Much of what might be considered personal information about directors of public companies is in the public domain. It is usually a legal obligation to disclose:

- › Names of executive directors
- › Names of non-executive directors, and whether they are independent or shareholders
- › Shareholding
- › Board attendance record
- › Dates of directors' terms of office
- › Remuneration, including bonus, share options, pension plans, and benefits
- › Notice period
- › Termination payment
- › Potential conflicts of interest



Charitable donations

Companies vaunt their philanthropy in the annual report, detailing how much they have given away and how it has helped. They may support charities relevant to the nature of their business or let employees vote on recipients.



96%
Wessex Water
utility's customer
satisfaction score



Customer satisfaction

Overall, this section shows how the company works with customers to improve service and support. In monopoly and oligopoly industries, customer satisfaction is particularly important, as governments often set high targets. Wessex Water's annual review shows a customer satisfaction rating of 96 percent.